SKYNOSOFT
....WHERE BRANDS FLY

Email Design Playbook: Brand-Matched Emails in Claude Design

The process for taking a brand's website link and ending with a finished, on-brand email design. It works standalone, so you can run it for any brand you spot.

A Skynosoft guide by David Owoeye, DTC CRO and Email Retention Specialist.

The flow at a glance

1. Get the brand's website link
2. Build a design system from the link
3. Load the design system into Claude Design
4. Find a high-yield template that matches the brand's aesthetic
5. Download the template
6. Recreate it in Claude Design with a prompt
7. Optional: write copy for a different campaign angle
8. Fill any image gaps
9. QA before it goes anywhere
0. Turn the design into a Klaviyo email and schedule it

Step 1: Get the brand link

Start with the brand's live website URL. Nothing else is needed to begin.

Step 2: Build the design system from the link

> Start with a Claude Project for each brand. Create the project first, then build the design system inside it. Every later chat in that project (new emails, campaign angles, image prompts) opens with the brand's design system, voice and past work already in context, plus the project's memory. You never re-explain the brand, and each brand stays in its own space.

1. In Claude, create a new Project and name it after the brand.
2. Open a new chat inside that project.
3. Copy the Design system prompt from below. Replace [WEBSITE_URL] with the brand's link, paste it into the chat, and send.
4. Wait while Claude visits the site. It checks the homepage, a collections page and a product page, then collects the colors, fonts, images, buttons, voice and navigation. This takes several minutes. What Claude can read depends on your setup.
   - **With the Claude in Chrome extension (recommended, optional):** Claude may ask to use Chrome. Click Allow once. It then reads the live site, including the stylesheet, so you get exact colors, fonts and a full image list. If you decline, Claude stops and asks how you want to continue.
   - **Without the extension:** Claude reads the site's text only. Colors and fonts come back marked "approx" and the image list is short. You can paste the site's CSS into the chat to fill

the gaps, or install the extension and ask Claude to try again.

5. Claude gives you one HTML file with a tab for each section: Overview, Colors, Typography, Assets, Products, Components, Voice and Tone, Navigation. Open it and read through.
6. Check the Colors tab (see the warning below).
7. Save the file to the project's files so Claude remembers it in every chat inside this project. If Claude can't save it for you, download the file, open the project page, click Add next to Context, and upload it. Check it shows in the list.

> From here on, open every new chat for this brand inside this same project.

> Check the color labels. "Confirmed" means pulled from the CSS or a source file. "Approx" means visually estimated. Exact values usually sit in the theme CSS (base.css or theme.css).

> Upgrade the Voice and Tone tab when you can. If the brand has real founder material, like video transcripts or brand voice guidelines, give it to Claude and ask it to rebuild the tab as numbered rules: signature phrases, words to avoid, spelling convention, email tone, sign-off. Example: for the brand nueday, we used the founders' TikTok transcripts. Anything unconfirmed, like a sign-off, stays open until the brand confirms it.

Design system prompt

```
Create a complete design system for this brand's website: [WEBSITE_URL]

Go through the live site yourself. Fetch the homepage, a collections page, and at least one
product page. Pull real data from the site, not guesses.

Extract and organize:

1. BRAND IDENTITY
- Brand name, tagline, positioning
- Announcement bar text and any active promo
- Market (country, currency, niche)

2. COLORS
- Fetch the theme CSS (base.css, theme.css or similar) and pull the exact hex values for
primary, secondary, accent, background, text, border and sale colors
- If you can't reach the CSS, mark those colors "approx". Mark everything else "confirmed"

3. TYPOGRAPHY
- Every font family on the site and its role (heading or body)
- Weights, sizes, and line heights where visible

4. ASSETS
- Every image URL from the site: logo (all versions), hero images, product images,
lifestyle images, badges, certification icons, and social share image
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- Give each as a full, copyable URL with a label for what it is
- Only list URLs you actually found on the site. Never invent one

5. COMPONENTS
- Buttons (label, background, text color, radius, padding)
- Product card structure (fields in order)
- Trust bar, nav, footer layout

6. VOICE & TONE
- Headline patterns, copy style, words the brand uses and avoids

7. NAVIGATION
- Full menu structure and collection URL slugs

Output one self-contained HTML file with a tab for each section above. Make every hex code
and image URL click-to-copy. Flag anything you could not confirm.
```

Step 3: Load the design system into Claude Design

Claude Design needs the brand's design system before it can design emails that look like the brand. You already have it: it's the HTML file Claude made in Step 2.

1. Go back to the chat in your brand's Claude Project where Claude built the design system.
2. Download the HTML file, or copy its contents.
3. Open Claude Design. In the box on the home screen, click the Design system dropdown, then the + button, and choose Create here.
4. In the Company name and blurb box, write the brand name and one line about it (for example: AG1, daily greens powder brand). Then scroll down and upload the HTML file in Add fonts, logos and assets. There is no box to paste it into.
5. Paste this backup note in the Any other notes box. Replace [WEBSITE_URL] with the brand's link. Then click Continue to generation and Generate.

```
Get any other information or assets you might need from the brand's website: [WEBSITE_URL]
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The backup note lets Claude Design go to the website itself if the file is missing something, like an image or a detail.

Generation takes about 5 minutes. Keep the tab open and don't open the same project in a second tab. If you see "Your other tab is working on a request" or "Connection interrupted", close any other tab of the project and click Retry. When it finishes, a warning about missing brand fonts is normal. The fonts are licensed, so Claude Design uses stand-ins. Carry on.

Optional: continue the brand's existing look

If the brand already has past email designs and wants to keep that aesthetic, give Claude Design some to learn from. Add either of these along with the design system file:

- Upload a few of the brand's past email designs.
- Or download a local copy of the Figma file that contains the emails, and upload it.

Step 4: Find a high-yield template

A "template" here is a reference email that Claude Design copies the structure and look from. Pick one that matches the brand's aesthetic and the campaign idea you need. It can be either of these:

- An editable email template.
- A real email a brand actually sent. It isn't editable, but that's fine, because you only need it as a reference.

Where to find one

1. **Email galleries (also called email archives).** These are sites that collect real emails from brands. Examples: Milled, Email Inspire, Email Donut, Really Good Emails. Search by niche, campaign type (like Black Friday or welcome) or style.
2. **Templates from other email marketers.** Many share or sell editable templates you can use as a reference.
3. **Subscribe to top brands.** Sign up to the emails of brands known for quality email design. Choose brands in the niche you're working in, or outside it when their look or campaign idea fits what the brand you're working on needs. Over time you build your own collection to pull from.

Pick a quality design from a source you trust, and one that suits the brand's look and the campaign.

Some galleries show a quick "verify you're human" check before they open. Complete it and carry on. If a gallery still won't open, use another from the list. On Really Good Emails, browsing by category (for example Promotional) is easier than searching for the brand.

Step 5: Download the template

How you save it depends on what kind of template you picked.

A real email from a brand

(from Milled, another email gallery, or your own inbox)

1. Take a full screenshot of the whole email, top to bottom. Use your browser's full-page screenshot option or a full-page screenshot extension. If you can't, take several screenshots as you scroll and join them.
2. Crop the screenshot so only the email shows.

A Figma email template

Export it from Figma in high quality.

Keep the file somewhere easy to find. You'll attach it in Step 6.

Step 6: Recreate the template in Claude Design

Claude Design builds an email that matches the template and adjusts the copy to the brand.

Sending a different type of campaign than the template was made for? Do Step 7 first, then come back here.

1. In Claude Design, on the home screen, look at the Design system box. It may default to a different brand. Click it and pick this brand's design system.
2. Start a new email design and attach the template you downloaded in Step 5.
3. Copy the Email design prompt below, fill in the [BRACKETS], and paste it in.
4. Want anything extra? Add your own instructions beneath the prompt.
5. Send it and review the result.

Email design prompt

Fill in these before you paste:

- [BRAND NAME] and [WEBSITE_URL]: the brand and its website.
- [BRAND FONT]: the brand's main font, from its design system.
- [LANGUAGE]: the language the email copy should be in.
- [LANGUAGE 1] and [LANGUAGE 2]: the two languages for the toggle in the last line of the prompt.
- [CAMPAIGN TYPE]: for example, Black Friday early access.
- Last line: delete it if the email only needs one language.

```
Design this email for [BRAND NAME] ([WEBSITE_URL]) according exactly to the reference email
attached. Pay attention to the tiny details: the gradients, the transitions between
sections, the parts that are large and small, emphasized, shadows, layers, vectors, visual
illustrations and elements.

Build it so the effects and styling carry over when imported into Canva or Figma.

Width: 600px.

Get all media from the website.

Technical requirements (must be met before delivery):

- Export-safe: the design must export cleanly to PNG and import into Canva or Figma. Load
no fonts or stylesheets from external servers like Google Fonts. Load [BRAND FONT] only
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from local files.
- Icons: no icon fonts. Render every icon as a transparent PNG (or the brand's own SVG)
saved in assets/icons/.
- Image weight: shrink every photo to 2x its display size, at most 1200px on the long side,
and save it as a JPEG (quality about 0.82, under about 300 KB). Keep the whole email under
about 3 MB.
- Media: use the [BRAND NAME] design system assets first. If you need an image from
[WEBSITE_URL] that isn't in the library, tell me which one instead of skipping it.
- Layers: build each gradient, shadow and photo as its own element. No CSS filters, blend
modes, clip-paths or masks, since these don't survive import.
- Typography: no overlapping headline lines. Line-height at least 1.0 on stacked bold
lines.
- Verify: export a test PNG before delivering and fix anything that fails.

Copy: [LANGUAGE], in [BRAND NAME]'s voice. Flag any product claim not confirmed on
[WEBSITE_URL].

The attached reference is not a strict layout. Adapt it to fit [BRAND NAME]'s own look and
feel, and make it suit this campaign type: [CAMPAIGN TYPE]. Make it visually rewarding and
engaging in a way that stays true to the brand, whether its style is bold and vibrant or
calm and minimal.

Also add a toggle that switches the email between [LANGUAGE 1] and [LANGUAGE 2].
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Step 7: Different campaign angle (optional)

- Use this when you have a promo template but want to send a different type of campaign with it.
- Give the template to Claude first, along with the campaign angle. Claude writes copy for that angle while keeping the template's structure. Then take that copy into Claude Design.

How to do it

1. Open a new chat inside the brand's Claude Project, so Claude already knows the brand.
2. Attach the template (the screenshot or export from Step 5).
3. Copy the Campaign angle prompt below, fill in the [BRACKETS], and send it.
4. Read the copy Claude writes and edit anything that doesn't sound right.
5. Take the copy into Claude Design. Paste it beneath the Step 6 prompt and add: "Use this copy exactly as written."

Campaign angle prompt

Fill in these before you send:

- [BRAND NAME] and [WEBSITE_URL]: the brand and its website.
- [CAMPAIGN ANGLE]: the type of email you want to send, like a welcome email, a restock, or early access.

- [OFFER OR KEY MESSAGE]: what the email should say or offer. Write "none" if there isn't one.
- [WHO RECEIVES IT]: the audience.
- [LANGUAGE]: the language of the copy.

```
I'm designing an email for [BRAND NAME] ([WEBSITE_URL]). The attached email is a reference
for structure only.

Campaign angle: [CAMPAIGN ANGLE]
Offer or key message: [OFFER OR KEY MESSAGE]
Audience: [WHO RECEIVES IT]
Language: [LANGUAGE]

The reference may be for a different type of campaign, but I want to send this campaign
angle using the same layout.

Write the copy for every section of the email and keep the reference's structure: the same
sections, in the same order, with similar copy length in each. Rewrite what each section
says so it fits my campaign angle instead of the reference's original campaign.

Use [BRAND NAME]'s voice, from the design system in this project. Use only products,
details and claims confirmed on [WEBSITE_URL] or that I give you. Don't invent discounts,
dates or numbers, and flag anything you're unsure about. If my angle needs a section the
reference doesn't have, or the reference has a section that doesn't fit, tell me instead of
changing the structure on your own.

Give me the copy in the order it appears in the email: subject line, preview text, then
each section with its headline, body text and button text.
```

Step 8: Images

Your email needs images, like a hero shot, product photos and lifestyle pictures. If the brand's website doesn't have images that fit, generate them from image prompts. Let AI write those prompts for you.

Pick the case that matches your template

- **The template already has images in it.** Take the template into ChatGPT and ask it to write well detailed image prompts for the images inside the email design.
- **The template is blank, with no images.** Ask Claude to give you image prompts for the template. Do this in the brand's Claude Project, so Claude already knows the brand.

How to do it

1. Attach the template to the chat.
2. Copy the Image prompt request below, fill in the [BRACKETS], and send it.
3. Take each prompt it writes to your image generator.
4. Generate each image 2 to 3 times and pick the best.

5. Check the product's shape and label against the real product. AI often gets labels and caps wrong.
6. Get the brand's approval before the images go into the email.

Image prompt request

Fill in these before you send:

- [BRAND NAME] and [WEBSITE_URL]: the brand and its website.
- [CAMPAIGN TYPE]: for example, Black Friday early access. Only needed if the template is blank.
- [BRAND LOOK]: the brand's image style, like photorealistic, bright and clean, soft natural light.
- [PALETTE HEX CODES]: the brand's colors, from its design system.
- [PRODUCT DESCRIPTION]: what the real products look like, like shape, colors and label.

ChatGPT doesn't have your design system, so paste the colors and product details into the brackets. In the brand's Claude Project, Claude already has them.

```
Attached is an email design template. For [BRAND NAME] ([WEBSITE_URL]), write a well
detailed image prompt for every image in the email design (for example the hero, the
product shots, the review card, the product grid and the closing image). If the template is
blank, suggest the image slots that suit a [CAMPAIGN TYPE] email.

Start with one shared style note that I can paste at the top of every prompt. Base it on
the brand's look: [BRAND LOOK], these exact colors: [PALETTE HEX CODES], minimal props, and
"no text overlays unless specified".

Then for each image give me: the slot name, the aspect ratio, and a detailed prompt
describing the subject, setting, lighting, camera angle and mood. Use the real products:
[PRODUCT DESCRIPTION].
```

Step 9: QA checklist

- ☐ Copy is in the brand's voice, not the template's. Swap out template language.
- ☐ Remove claims that aren't true for the brand (for example, "clinically proven").
- ☐ Review blocks use real reviews only. If there are none, cut the block.
- ☐ Only reference site elements you've confirmed live and visible, not just in the page code.
- ☐ Color hexes are marked confirmed, not approx, before production use.
- ☐ Generated product images verified against the real product.

Step 10: Turn the design into a Klaviyo email

> Claude Design gives you a design. This step turns it into a real email you can send from Klaviyo.

> Before you start: connect your Klaviyo account through the Klaviyo MCP. If you'll use Option B for images, connect the Shopify MCP too. Check which Klaviyo account is connected, because it may be a live client account. For a practice run, tell Claude to create only a template with "TEST (delete me)" in the name, to create no campaign, and to send the preview to your own address only.

10.1 Hand the design to Claude Code

1. In Claude Design, click Share, then More formats and apps, then Send next to Claude Code. In the "Hand off to Claude Code" window, choose the Web session tab. It needs no setup.
2. Claude Code asks what you want to make. Choose "a functional email template you can push to Klaviyo." (You must have connected your Klaviyo account using the Klaviyo MCP.) If it asks how to handle gradients, choose "Flatten hero to one image."
3. Claude builds the email as real HTML. Parts that can't be live text, like gradients, glows and special headlines, become images. Photos and icons come from your design assets.

10.2 Get the images hosted

Klaviyo only accepts images that are hosted online. Files on your computer won't work. Pick one option:

Option A: upload by hand

1. In Klaviyo, go to Content, then Images and brand, and upload the images.
2. Klaviyo renames every upload to a random ID. Tell Claude when you're done, and it matches each upload to its source file by file size.

Option B: use Shopify

1. Connect the Shopify MCP. Use a Shopify dev store, or the brand's real store if you have access to it.
2. Claude uploads the images to the store's Files. Each image gets a public link.
3. Claude takes those links and puts the images into Klaviyo.

If Claude can't upload to Klaviyo itself, use Option A.

10.3 Give Claude the layout rules up front

Paste this at the start of the build, before Claude writes any HTML. Replace the last line with where your buttons should go.

```
Layout rules for this email:

- The layout must look the same on mobile and desktop. No columns that stack or wrap on
mobile. Build product grids as a fixed two-column table with percentage widths. Button text
stays on one line.
- Everything fits in 600px. Every section is full width up to a maximum of 600px. No
sideways scrolling.
- The design must not depend on style rules, because some email apps ignore or drop them.
Put the real look directly on each element. Use style rules only for small extras. Test the
email with the style rules removed.
- Gmail drops all style rules if even one uses an unsupported selector, so avoid those.
- Use Klaviyo's own tags: {% unsubscribe 'label' %} for unsubscribe and {% web_view 'label'
%} for view in browser. Do not use {% unsubscribe_url %}, it breaks the preview.
- Links: every button goes to [PAGE]. Keep the product-page links.
```

If you want to use personalisation in your email, Klaviyo has tags for that too. For example, {{ first_name|default:'there' }} shows the first name, or "there" if Klaviyo doesn't have one. Tell Claude where to use it, like the greeting line. Always keep the fallback after default:.

> Why these rules exist: a product grid built to wrap collapses from two columns to one on phones. The fix is a fixed two-column table with percentage widths. Also check that your Claude Design brief already says where each button links.

10.4 Send a test and check it on your phone

1. Send a test email to yourself.
2. Open it in the real Gmail app on your phone. Don't judge it from Gmail in Chrome. Gmail in Chrome can show sideways scrolling that the Gmail app doesn't. Fit the layout to 600px anyway so it holds up everywhere.
3. Check three things: the columns are still side by side; button text is on one line; there is no sideways scrolling.
4. Send as many tests as you need before scheduling.

10.5 Create the campaign and schedule it

1. Create the campaign in Klaviyo with the finished email.
2. For a send time like "7:08 pm recipient time," turn on local-time sending.
3. Claude asks you to confirm before any test send or scheduling. Check it, then confirm.

> Expect the inbox version to look simpler than the Claude Design one. Email apps can't render curved section edges, gradients, glows or custom fonts, so these become flat shapes, images or stand-in fonts. Photos and icons only show if they are hosted (10.2). If you skip hosting, they turn into colored blocks.
